



Specimen book

BY: YUMNA EL HENDI

A collage of various letters and symbols in different colors and styles. The central element is a large, bold, beige letter 'R'. Surrounding it are several other characters: a blue 'S' at the top left, a red 'M' at the top center, a blue 'R' on the left, a white 'E' below the 'R', a red 'Q' below the 'E', a blue 'r' on the right, a red 'F' at the top right, a blue 'k' below the 'F', a white 'y' at the bottom right, and a red '1' above the 'y'. The background is dark and textured, with some faint, larger letters visible in the background.



This book explores three influential typefaces and the designers behind them. Through history, anatomy, and real-world applications, it demonstrates how typography shapes communication, branding, and visual identity.



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Adrian Frutiger

DISCIPLINE. CLARITY. HUMANISM.

Adrian Frutiger (1928-2015) was one of the most influential type designers of the twentieth century. Throughout his career, he created typefaces that emphasized readability, balance, and timeless elegance. His work transformed transportation systems, branding, publishing, and digital interfaces around the world.

Frutiger believed typography should never distract the reader. Instead, letters should communicate information with clarity while maintaining

visual beauty. His philosophy helped shape modern typography and continues to influence designers today.

Notable Typefaces

- Univers
- Frutiger
- Avenir

Design Philosophy

"If you remember the shape of your spoon at lunch, it has a poor design."

Legacy

Today Adrian Frutiger's typefaces appear in airports, hospitals, corporate branding, books,

and digital products worldwide. His work remains a benchmark for functional typography.



"If you remember the shape of your spoon at lunch, it has a poor design."

– Adrian Frutiger

AVENIR

HUMANIST SANS SERIF

Designer

Adrian Frutiger

Released

1988

Classification

Humanist Sans Serif

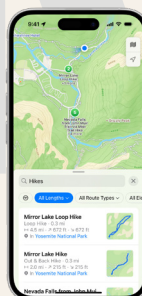
Character Set

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789
! ? @ # \$ % & * ()

Weights

Ultra Light
Condensed
Roman
Medium
Bold Condensed
Heavy

Applications



Avenir was designed by Adrian Frutiger in 1988 as a modern interpretation of the geometric sans serif tradition. While inspired by classic geometric typefaces such as Futura, Avenir introduces subtle optical adjustments that improve readability and give the letters a warmer, more human appearance. Today it is widely used in branding, editorial design, signage, and digital interfaces because of its clarity and versatility.

Anatomy

Round terminals
Open counters
Balanced x-height
Geometric circles
Humanist proportions

"A typeface should never call attention to itself."

– Adrian Frutiger

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789

0123456789

BASKERVILLE

TRANSITIONAL SERIF

Designer

John Baskerville

Released

1757

Classification

Transitional Serif

Character Set

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

! ? @ # \$ % & * ()

Weights

Regular

Baskerville was designed by English printer John Baskerville in 1757 to improve the quality of printed books. By increasing the contrast between thick and thin strokes and refining the letterforms, he created a typeface that combined elegance with exceptional readability. Today Baskerville remains a favourite for books, magazines, luxury branding, and academic publishing because of its timeless appearance.

Anatomy

High contrast

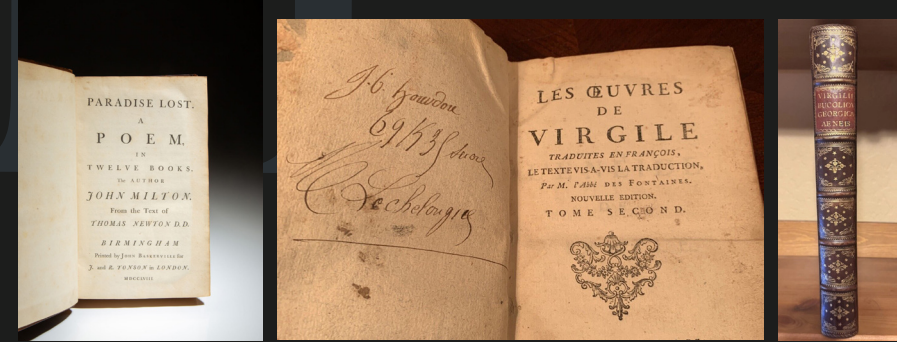
Sharp serifs

Elegant proportions

Classical appearance

Excellent readability

Applications



MODERN (DIDONE) SERIF

Designer

Giambattista Bodoni

Released

1798

Classification

Modern (Didone) Serif

Character Set

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

! ? @ # \$ % & * ()

Weights

Poster Compressed

Condensed

Condensed Italic

Condensed Bold

Condensed Bold Italic

Regular

Italic

Bold

Bold Italic

Black

Black Italic

Bodoni was designed by Italian typographer Giambattista Bodoni and published in 1798. It represents the Modern, or Didone, style of typography, characterized by dramatic contrast between thick and thin strokes, vertical stress, and refined serifs. Bodoni became a symbol of elegance and precision, and it remains widely used in luxury branding, fashion magazines, book publishing, and editorial design because of its sophisticated appearance.

Anatomy

High stroke contrast

Hairline serifs

Vertical stress

Geometric precision

Elegant proportions

Applications



CD
Dior

"Letters should combine beauty with usefulness."

– *Giambattista Bodoni*



TYPOGRAPHY

Specimen book

THE ART OF TYPE
IS THE ART OF
COMMUNICATION.

Typography is more than choosing a font.
It is the balance of form and function,
where every letter shapes the way ideas
are seen, understood, and remembered.

Designed by
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Typography Specimen Book • 2026

SOURCES

Research

- Manuale Tipografico – Giambattista Bodoni
- The Elements of Typographic Style – Robert Bringhurst
- Signs and Symbols – Adrian Frutiger
- Meggs' History of Graphic Design – Meggs & Purvis

IMAGES

- Apple Newsroom
- Un Bison à Morgat
- FreeFonts.io
- The New York Times
- Logo-Marque
- Oxford University Press
- Penguin Books

AI PROMPTS

Historical summaries generated
using ChatGPT from instructor-
directed research.
Typography spread copy refined
using ChatGPT.